THE

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT PLAYBOOK

FOR TRAINING & CONSULTING PROFESSIONALS

Corporate Trainers · Business Coaches · HR Consultants · Management Consultancies

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Strategy · Sales Process · Client Psychology · Content Engine

Synthesised from

Rain Making · *The Trusted Advisor* · *The Platinum Rule*

They Ask, You Answer · *Built to Sell*

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SECTION 1: THE GROWTH ENGINE

Every professional services business runs on one formula, whether the founder knows it or not:

$$\text{Revenue} = N \times B \times F$$

This formula structures everything in this playbook. Every activity you do, every meeting you take, every article you write should improve at least one of these three variables. Growing all three simultaneously creates geometric growth.

What Each Variable Means

- **N (Network Size):** HR directors, L&D managers, CEOs, and business owners who know your practice exists. For solo practitioners, this sits around 50–80. Target: 200–300.
- **B (% Buyers):** The percentage of your network who actually book you. For solo practitioners with early-stage relationships, this is typically 2–3%. Target: 5–8% through deeper trust and programme-based engagements.
- **F (Average Fee):** Your average engagement value. Most trainers undercharge because they sell individual workshop days instead of programmes. Moving from one-off sessions to annual training calendars or transformation programmes can triple this number.

The Compound Effect

Scenario	Network (N)	Buyers (B)	Avg Fee (F)	Revenue
Current state	80	2.5%	RM 8,000	RM 16,000
12-month target	250	6.5%	RM 35,000	RM 568,750

Same founder. Same team. Same expertise. The difference is a system that deliberately grows all three variables instead of hoping the phone rings.

The Trust Equation

Trust is the mechanism that converts N into B. People buy from professionals they trust:

$$\text{Trust} = (\text{Credibility} + \text{Reliability} + \text{Intimacy}) \div \text{Self-Orientation}$$

- **Credibility:** Your qualifications, certifications, client portfolio, published work, professional endorsements.
- **Reliability:** Do you deliver when you say you will? Consistency in small things builds enormous trust.

- **Intimacy:** Does the client feel safe telling you the real problem?
- **Self-Orientation (keep LOW):** Is your first instinct “how do I upsell?” or “what does this client actually need?” The client can feel the difference.

> *Key insight: Most firms over-invest in Credibility while ignoring Intimacy and Self-Orientation. The firms that win aren’t always the most qualified — they’re the ones clients trust most.*

How Trust Gets Weighted by Personality

Style	Trusts Through	Your Approach
Director (fast-paced, task-focused)	Credibility + Reliability	Be concise. Deliver results. Don’t waste their time.
Socialiser (fast-paced, people-focused)	Intimacy + Credibility	Build personal rapport. Show enthusiasm. Be visible.
Relater (slow-paced, people-focused)	Intimacy + Reliability	Be patient. Don’t rush. Show you care personally.
Thinker (slow-paced, task-focused)	Credibility (data-heavy)	Provide evidence. Be thorough. Let them analyse.

Four Layers, One Playbook

This document integrates four frameworks into a single workflow:

- **Layer 1 — The System:** What activities to do and when. How to grow N × B × F. (Rain Making)
- **Layer 2 — The Philosophy:** Who to be in every interaction. Show don’t claim. Listen before solving. (The Trusted Advisor)
- **Layer 3 — The Personalisation:** How to deliver Layer 1 using Layer 2 calibrated to each person’s style. (The Platinum Rule)
- **Layer 4 — The Content Engine:** What to publish, where to distribute, and how to use content as a sales tool. (They Ask, You Answer)

SECTION 2: MINDSET & IDENTITY

Before tactics or strategy, rewire how you think about selling. This section is conversational because mindset isn't a checklist — it's something you internalise over time.

Sales = Survival (Founder Edition)

If you don't sell, the practice doesn't exist. Whether you sell direct or through referral networks, you are the growth engine. The sooner you accept this as a core part of your professional identity, the sooner your practice starts growing.

Lack of Time Is No Excuse

You're genuinely busy — delivering programmes, designing content, managing clients. Everyone who succeeds at marketing is equally busy. The difference isn't available hours — it's what you treat as urgent versus important.

Delivering a workshop feels urgent because there's a date. Writing a LinkedIn article doesn't feel urgent because nobody's waiting. But that article, published consistently over six months, puts you in front of decision-makers who have never heard of your practice.

The Numbers Game

- **Cold approaches to get one meeting:** ~15–20
- **Meetings to get one engagement:** ~3–5
- **Proposals to get one PO:** ~2–3

Work backward from your revenue target. Three outreach attempts per week. Completely manageable — but only if you do it consistently.

The Emotional Roller Coaster

The emotional swings are amplified because the practice is yours. When a big engagement stalls, it feels personal. When work comes through a referral partner, it feels like a half-win.

When you lose, don't spiral — debrief, learn, move on. When you win, celebrate. Notice when a stalled deal affects your motivation for outreach. Notice when a win makes you complacent. Both are traps.

Production Mindset vs Marketing Mindset

Stop Maximising Billable Time at the Expense of Marketing

The professional who always chooses delivery over marketing is optimising for this month at the expense of next quarter.

Marketing Time Is Investment, Not Waste

On average, 70% of the buying decision is made before a prospect ever talks to you. That means the blog post, the LinkedIn article, the case study on your website — that's where the sale actually happens. The meeting just confirms a decision your content already influenced.

Content Never Sleeps

A blog post about leadership training costs works at midnight when an HR director is researching options before a budget meeting. It works on public holidays. It teaches 1,000 people at once. The time invested compounds in ways that workshops cannot.

You're Not a Pest

By touch 3 or 4 of your outreach sequence, your instinct will be "I'm bothering this person." Most people aren't annoyed by professional, courteous follow-up — they're just busy.

Selling IS Practising Your Profession

When you help an HR director see that their team's performance issue is a leadership gap rather than a skills gap — that IS your expertise applied to diagnosis. You're not selling. You're doing what you do best.

Porpoising and the Alice Trap

> *Porpoising: the radical swing from too much work to too little, caused by stop-start marketing. The fix: always have at least one marketing activity running, no matter how busy you are.*

> *The Alice Trap: getting so busy delivering that you never transition to selling. Always have marketing underway, no matter how much delivery work is in progress.*

Your Credibility Stack

Credibility is expertise plus presence. Your stack, in order of impact:

1. Recognised Certifications — HRDF-registered trainer, ICF-credentialed coach, certified facilitator. These are the qualifications HR departments check before processing your PO.
2. Methodology Credentials — certified in DISC, MBTI, Gallup StrengthsFinder, Design Thinking, Lean Six Sigma. These signal structured, evidence-based delivery.
3. Client Portfolio — when an HR director hears you've delivered programmes for recognised companies, their brain processes "credible" faster than any certification.
4. Domain Knowledge Depth — be the most knowledgeable person in the room about your specialisation. When you diagnose an organisational issue in a way that helps them understand their people problem better than they did before, nobody asks about your academic background.

5. Visible Enthusiasm — when you light up talking about leadership development, team dynamics, or organisational change, that energy is a credibility signal that can't be faked — and for trainers, it's also a preview of your delivery style.

> *When the qualification question comes up: state your experience, certifications, endorsements, and client list — then move on. Defensiveness is self-orientation.*

Sayings to Keep in Your Head

- "It's about the client, not about me."
- "Who am I thinking about right now?"
- "The answer is a better question."
- "The problem is rarely what the client said it was at first."
- "I don't have to prove myself every 10 seconds."
- "Relax — I know more than I think I know."
- "Am I claiming trust or demonstrating it?"
- "If my gut tells me something's wrong, talk about it."

SECTION 3: GETTING KNOWN

One-to-many activities that build reputation. These grow N and B simultaneously. Core principle: show, don't claim.

The Big 5: What to Write About (Forever)

Five types of content consistently drive the most traffic, leads, and trust:

Topic	Why It Works	Example
Cost & Pricing	Every HR director researches training costs first. The practice that answers honestly wins trust.	"How Much Does a Corporate Training Programme Cost in Malaysia?"
Problems & Limitations	Addressing what can go wrong builds more trust than promising transformation.	"5 Reasons Your Last Leadership Programme Didn't Change Behaviour"
Comparisons	HR teams compare anyway. Be the one who helps them decide honestly.	"In-House Training vs External Facilitator: Which Delivers Better ROI?"
Best in Class	People search "best" before every purchase. Own that conversation.	"What Makes the Best Corporate Trainer? 7 Things HR Directors Should Look For"
Reviews	Honest assessments of methods and approaches build authority.	"Our Honest Review of DISC vs MBTI for Team Development Programmes"

For any service you offer, ask five questions: What does it cost? What are the problems? How does it compare? Who's the best? What are the reviews? That generates dozens of topics on demand.

The Content Engine: Write Once, Distribute Everywhere

One blog post per week answering a Big 5 question. That single post becomes the source for every other channel:

- **Blog post:** The comprehensive piece. Lives on your website, builds SEO, discoverable by HR directors searching "leadership training Malaysia" two years from now. The only channel you fully own.
- **LinkedIn:** Retell the same topic as a personal insight. "Last month we ran a leadership programme. Day 1, nobody wanted to be there. Day 3, the CEO asked us to expand to all departments. Here's what changed."
- **Facebook:** Same as LinkedIn version. Share in Malaysian HR, L&D, and SME owner groups.
- **WhatsApp Channel:** Not the full post. Pull one insight and make it snackable. Links to the full blog post. Read rates in Malaysia are 85–95%.

- **Quarterly email mailer:** Curate the best blog posts from the quarter into a single email.
- **Pre-meeting handout:** Print or PDF your best blog posts. Send before meetings. The content already exists.

One hour writing the blog post, one hour distributing across channels. Two hours total. 50 posts in a year gives you more educational content than probably every competitor combined.

> *Repurpose across time. The blog post written in March becomes a proposal appendix in July, feeds into the October mailer, and gets updated next February. Every piece of content has a 12-month lifecycle.*

The Ostrich Trap

"We'd better not address pricing on the website. Let's wait until we're face-to-face." But when was the last time you looked up how much something costs and the company didn't answer? You left and found someone who would.

The topics that feel most uncomfortable — how much your programmes cost, why some training doesn't work, honest comparisons between in-house and external approaches — are precisely the topics HR directors are researching right now. The trainer who answers them builds trust. The one who hides loses the engagement.

Writing & Publishing (Beyond Blog)

The blog is your primary channel. But some writing targets audiences the blog won't reach:

- MIHRM (Malaysian Institute of Human Resource Management) publications
- HRDF newsletter and knowledge portal
- SME Corp publications (SME development angle)
- Your company blog with proper SEO

Speaking

Topics That Generate Leads

- "Building a Learning Culture: A Practical Framework for HR Leaders"
- "Beyond Kirkpatrick: Measuring Real Behavioural Change After Training"
- "The ROI Conversation: How to Justify L&D Spend to Your CFO"

> *Give the speech → write up as blog post → distribute through the content engine. One effort, five outputs.*

Taster Sessions / Diagnostic Workshops as Lead Generation

- Run free/low-cost “Leadership Diagnostic” or “Team Effectiveness” taster sessions for HR directors and L&D managers
- Limit to 15–20 attendees for quality interaction
- Use real (anonymised) engagement data from your programmes
- During breaks, have 1-on-1 conversations about their training challenges
- Follow up personally within 48 hours with every attendee
- Track: who attended → who engaged → who has a budget → opportunity in CRM

The Conversion Funnel

Taster session attendee → asks about their organisation → needs assessment (RM 5–15K) → customised programme design → multi-cohort delivery (RM 30–100K) → coaching follow-through → annual L&D partnership.

Social Content That Builds Credibility

DON’T	DO
“We completed a leadership workshop for 40 managers. Contact us for your training needs!”	“This is what happens when you run a leadership programme without a needs assessment first. This company spent RM 80K on communication skills training. The real problem was role clarity. Most HR teams don’t discover this until the post-training survey comes back flat.”

The first is advertising. The second demonstrates expertise.

Direct Mail & Email (Quarterly Cadence)

Each quarter, curate the best Big 5 blog posts into a themed email:

- **Q1:** “2026 L&D Planning Guide” — covering HRDF claim procedures, budget benchmarks, and programme design principles
- **Q2:** Case study mailer — anonymised results showing behavioural change and business impact post-programme
- **Q3:** HRDF update — changes in claimable schemes, new levy rates, emerging priority areas
- **Q4:** “Planning Your 2027 Training Calendar” — timed to annual budget season

Every mailer gives something useful. None say “contact us.” That’s the “go first” principle.

SECTION 4: BUILDING & MAINTAINING YOUR NETWORK

Who You Need to Know

Category	Examples	Why They Matter
Direct Buyers	HR directors, L&D managers, CEOs, business owners, department heads	They sign POs or approve training budgets
Influencers	Line managers, team leads, previous participants	They recommend trainers after a good experience
Referral Partners	Complementary consultants, recruitment firms, other trainers in different domains	They encounter your prospects in every HR meeting
Gatekeepers	Procurement, HR executives (not directors), HRDF administrators	They control vendor registration and PO processing
Knowledge Sources	HRDF contacts, MIHRM leaders, corporate L&D community	They tell you about upcoming training budgets and RFPs early

Trade Associations

Join and get active. Volunteer for committees:

- MIHRM — volunteer for events or committees. Direct access to HR directors across industries
- MIM (Malaysian Institute of Management) — management professionals who buy training
- ICF Malaysia Chapter — coaching community with referral potential
- SME Corp networks — access to SME owners who are your direct buyers
- Industry-specific chambers — FMM, AMCHAM, EUROCHAM give access to MNC L&D budgets

Network Quality

Target 200–300 contacts. Assess each across four dimensions:

- **Purchasing power:** Can they hire you?
- **Access & influence:** Connected to decision-makers?
- **Information value:** Early opportunity intelligence?
- **Referral willingness:** Actively recommend you?

> *The Oscar Principle: always introduce people who can help each other. Connectors get called first.*

Style-Adapted Relationship Maintenance

Style	Maintenance Approach	Frequency
Director	Short, results-focused updates.	Monthly email, quarterly call
Socialiser	Social engagement. Comment on posts. Invite to events.	Bi-weekly touchpoint
Relater	Personal check-ins.	Monthly personal message
Thinker	Technical content. Research, data.	Quarterly deep-value email

SECTION 5: THE SALES PROCESS

Getting the Meeting

The 4-Touch Outreach Sequence

- **Touch 1 (Day 1):** LinkedIn connection — brief, specific, no pitch
- **Touch 2 (Day 2–3):** Email — value-focused
- **Touch 3 (Day 4–5):** WhatsApp — conversational, brief
- **Touch 4 (Day 7–10):** Phone call — now warm

> *"I noticed [Company] recently restructured their regional teams. Organisations going through structural change often see a dip in manager effectiveness. Would 15 minutes be useful to share what we've seen work in similar transitions?"*

The Learning Call

> *"I'm researching how Malaysian companies approach leadership development for mid-level managers. Could I get 15 minutes of your time to understand your current approach?"*

Tracking Your Numbers

Record every outreach attempt and its outcome in your CRM. After 3 months, you'll know your actual conversion ratios.

Assignment Selling

Most practitioners book a meeting and show up. Assignment selling means sending the prospect educational content BEFORE the meeting so they arrive informed, pre-qualified, and already trusting you.

How It Works

Old approach: Prospect calls, asks for a training proposal. "Sure, how many participants?" No idea what the real organisational issue is. You quote a day rate.

New approach: "Of course I'd love to discuss. But before we meet, I'm going to send you two things: our guide on what makes training programmes actually change behaviour, and a case study showing results from a similar organisation. Have a look — it'll make our conversation much more productive."

90% of prospects say yes. For the 10% who refuse: if a prospect won't spend 10 minutes becoming informed, they're almost certainly buying on price alone.

What to Send

This is where your Big 5 blog posts become sales tools:

- **Pricing inquiry:** Send your "How Much Does Corporate Training Cost?" blog post
- **Comparing trainers:** Send your comparison article
- **First-time buyer:** Send your guide to choosing the right training partner
- **Worried about ROI:** Send your article on measuring behavioural change
- **Any prospect:** Send a relevant case study from a similar industry or challenge

Why Teaching Gives You Authority

The rights of a teacher are greater than those of a salesperson. A teacher can assign homework. A teacher can set expectations. Assignment selling shifts the dynamic from selling to teaching.

The Follow-Up After Sending

Call before the meeting: "Did you get a chance to go through the guide I sent?" If yes: the meeting starts at a different level. If no: "Take 10 minutes, it'll make our meeting more productive."

Running the Meeting

Pre-Meeting Preparation

- Check their style in CRM
- Research their company and challenges
- Prepare first five minutes for their style
- Set intention: "It's about them, not me."

The First Five Minutes

6. Personal link: something specific about their organisation.
7. Agenda statement: "I'd like to understand your approach and share how we've helped similar organisations."
8. Positioning statement: Lead with a RESULT.
9. Stage-setting anecdote: One brief real story. Under 30 seconds.
10. The Big Question: "What's the biggest challenge you're facing?" Then listen.

Questions That Surface Real Needs

- "What's the biggest people challenge your organisation is facing right now?"
- "How do you currently measure whether training programmes are working?"
- "Have you had programmes that didn't deliver the expected results?"
- "What does your HRDF utilisation look like this year?"
- "If you could change one thing about how your organisation develops its people, what would it be?"

Buying signals:

- **"We've been meaning to address our manager pipeline"** — recognised need
- **"Our HRDF levy is piling up"** — budget pressure to spend = urgent
- **"Last trainer just did generic slides"** — competitor weakness
- **"The CEO is asking about our talent bench"** — top-down mandate

> *The "What else?" technique: The real problem usually surfaces second or third, not first.*

Framing the Problem

DON'T	DO
Client: "We need a 2-day leadership workshop." Vendor: "We can do that for RM 8,000 per day."	Adviser: "A 2-day workshop is a starting point. What you're really trying to solve is sustainable behaviour change in 25 managers who influence 200 employees. Two days alone gives knowledge transfer but rarely changes habits. The real value is a 3-month learning journey with coaching follow-through that actually moves your engagement scores."

How Framing Shifts by Style

- **Director:** Business impact in one line. "This isn't a training cost. It's a manager effectiveness investment that shows up in your turnover numbers."
- **Socialiser:** Vision and status. "Imagine presenting your CEO a leadership programme with measurable before-and-after impact data."
- **Relater:** Reassurance. "You've been investing in your people. This is about adding the follow-through layer that turns a good workshop into lasting change."
- **Thinker:** Evidence chain. Walk through the forgetting curve data, show why single-event training has a 15% retention rate, and present the programme design with measurement methodology.

Naming and Claiming

When you sense something unspoken, name it. Use softening phrases:

- "I might be reading this wrong, but it sounds like the real concern isn't the training content — it's whether participants will actually apply it back at their desks."
- "At the risk of overstepping, I'm noticing that the bigger issue might be managerial role clarity rather than communication skills."

- "You've probably thought about this already, but the engagement scores combined with the recent restructure suggest a trust issue rather than a skills gap."

Envisioning the Future State

Help them see what "good" looks like before you ask for commitment:

"Imagine if 90 days after the programme, you could show your CEO a dashboard with before-and-after data: engagement scores, 360-degree feedback shifts, manager effectiveness ratings. Not just smiling faces on evaluation forms — actual behavioural change. That's what a learning journey looks like versus a workshop."

How the vision resonates by style:

- **Director:** The outcome. "Better managers, lower turnover, measurable ROI."
- **Socialiser:** The status. "Your CEO presentation shows a world-class L&D programme with proven impact."
- **Relater:** The stability. "Managers who are confident, teams that collaborate, no more firefighting."
- **Thinker:** The logic. "Evidence-based programme design with pre/post measurement at every stage. Full data trail."

Giving Advice Without Losing the Client

DON'T	DO
"Your approach is fundamentally flawed. You should have addressed this years ago."	"Based on what we've seen, there are areas that could use attention. Let me walk you through options and you decide what makes sense."

Advise clients like you're helping your parents — respectful, honest, always their decision.

The Disarmament Principle

When a prospect asks "why should I choose you?" the instinct is to pitch. The better move: disarm first.

"To be frank, we may not be the best fit. You've seen our proposal and others. Based on everything you've heard, do you feel we're the right choice?"

If they hesitate, you've surfaced a real objection. If they say yes, they've sold themselves.

The Assignment Selling Follow-Up

After the meeting, send targeted content instead of "just checking in":

"During our meeting, you mentioned concerns about [specific issue]. I've attached an article explaining [relevant topic]. Give it a look and I'll call Thursday to discuss."

Winning the Work

Style-Adapted Proposals

Style	Format	What They Read First
Director	2 pages max. Price upfront.	Price and timeline
Socialiser	Visual. Testimonials.	Who else you've worked with
Relater	Detailed process. Reassuring.	Implementation process
Thinker	Comprehensive. Methodology.	Technical approach

Universal proposal principles:

- Lead with THEIR problem statement using THEIR words
- Show you understood their constraints
- Present the service that fits their situation
- Include 2–3 anonymised case references — evidence, not claims
- No surprises — everything discussed verbally first

Handling "Price Is Too High"

- **Director:** What you get for the money. "Our fee includes needs assessment, customised design, and 90-day coaching follow-through. The next cheapest trainer gives you a generic slide deck."
- **Socialiser:** Relationship reassurance. "I hear you. Let me adjust the scope. The quality of facilitation won't change."
- **Relater:** Process comfort. "Let's start with one cohort and expand based on results. No commitment beyond the pilot."
- **Thinker:** ROI data. "Here's the comparison: our programme fee vs. the cost of replacing one disengaged manager."

When You Lose

- Debrief within 48 hours
- Push past vague reasons to find the real issue
- Track patterns in CRM
- Don't burn the bridge — follow up in 6 months

SECTION 6: DELIVERING & GROWING

During Delivery

- Confirm logistics 48 hours before. Send pre-work materials a week ahead.
- Provide same-day summary and photos after every session — HR needs these for internal reporting.
- Don't oversell the transformation. If a team is already functioning well, say so. The HR director who hears honest assessment trusts your diagnosis when issues DO surface.
- Include a "What's Next" section in every post-programme report — genuine development recommendations, not a sales pitch.
- Help them USE your deliverables — coach HR on presenting results to their CEO, building the case for continued investment, justifying HRDF claims.

Style-Adapted Behaviour During Delivery

- **Director (CEO/MD):** Brief them first. "Programme covers X, Y, Z. I'll have impact data for you in 90 days."
- **Socialiser (Enthusiastic HR Director):** Build the partnership. Share programme highlights. They'll champion you internally.
- **Relater (Cautious L&D Manager):** Check in regularly. "How are participants responding?" Don't disrupt their internal dynamics.
- **Thinker (Data-Driven HR):** Share your measurement framework upfront. Let them verify your assessment methodology.

The 4 Levels of Client Relationship

Level	Description	Revenue Implication
1. Service Provider	You do what you're asked.	One-off, easily replaced
2. Capable Expert	They trust your judgment.	Repeat work, some flexibility
3. Valued Resource	They seek your input beyond scope.	Annual contracts, premium pricing
4. Trusted Adviser	They involve you in strategy.	Multi-year partnerships, referrals

Post-Delivery Follow-Up Cadence

- **30 days:** "How are the participants applying the frameworks? Any resistance points I can help troubleshoot?"
- **90 days:** "Have you noticed any shift in the team dynamics we discussed? Happy to do a quick pulse check."

- **Ongoing:** Share relevant updates. “HRDF just announced changes to the claimable scheme structure — might affect your 2027 training plan. Happy to walk you through the implications.”

The Portal Service Strategy

The entry engagement for training and consulting firms is the needs assessment or diagnostic workshop. It’s affordable, answers an immediate question, gives you access to multiple stakeholders across the organisation, and naturally leads to a full programme design.

The Conversion Path

Needs assessment (RM 5–15K) → findings reveal real gaps → customised programme design → delivery across multiple cohorts (RM 30–100K) → coaching follow-through → annual L&D partnership → expansion to other departments.

Growing Accounts

The Trust-Transfer Problem

Trust is personal, not institutional. Three types of expansion:

- **Expand (deeper, same person):** Upgrading from basic to comprehensive. Easiest.
- **Broaden (same service, new person):** Getting introduced to a different decision maker. Medium.
- **Diversify (new person, new scope):** Expansion across divisions or locations. Hardest.

Asking for Referrals

Timing: only after delivering results they’re happy with:

- **Director:** Direct. “Who else in your network is dealing with similar people challenges?”
- **Socialiser:** Enthusiastic. “You’ve seen the results — anyone else who’d benefit?”
- **Relater:** Gentle. “If you think any HR colleagues would find this helpful, I’d welcome an introduction whenever it feels right.”
- **Thinker:** Factual. “Based on the results, similar organisations would benefit from this approach. Any you’d recommend?”

Price Increase Conversations

- **Director:** Direct. “Rates adjusted due to [reason]. New rate is RM X. Same facilitator, same quality.”
- **Socialiser:** Frame positively. “We’ve added coaching follow-through and enhanced assessments. Better outcomes. New rate reflects the upgrade.”
- **Relater:** Reassuring. “Everything stays the same — same facilitator, same approach. The adjustment is modest.”

- **Thinker:** Full breakdown. “Material costs up X%, assessment tools up Y%. New rate of RM Z. Attached: comparison showing programme value per participant.”

When to Turn Down Small Work

Every small one-off workshop you accept keeps your average fee low and occupies time that could pursue programme-level engagements. Know the difference between a needs assessment (strategic entry point — worth it) and a quick half-day filler session that has no path to a larger engagement (usually not worth it unless you need cashflow).

SECTION 7: YOUR 12-MONTH PLAN

Growth Formula Targets

Variable	Current	3-Month	6-Month	12-Month
N (Network)	___	___	___	___
B (% Buyers)	___	___	___	___
F (Avg Fee)	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___
Revenue	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___

The 3 Things to Do Tomorrow

11. Write one Big 5 blog post about your core service. Start with cost or problems — the topics nobody in training wants to publish. Distribute through the content engine.
12. Apply to speak at one MIHRM, MIM, or industry event in the next 3 months. A room full of HR directors is a room full of buyers.
13. Send one value-add email to 10 HR contacts — not a pitch, but useful content (L&D planning guide, case study, blog post link). Demonstrate the “go first” principle.

QUICK REFERENCE

Designed for pre-meeting prep. Print this section and keep it in your bag.

60-Second Style Identification

14. Fast-paced/assertive (Direct) or slow-paced/reserved (Indirect)?
15. Task-focused (Guarded) or people-focused (Open)?

	Task-Focused	People-Focused
Fast-Paced	DIRECTOR: Decisive, impatient	SOCIALISER: Enthusiastic, big-picture
Slow-Paced	THINKER: Analytical, cautious	RELATER: Patient, consensus-seeking

Style Warnings

- **Socialiser:** They'll say yes enthusiastically then delay paperwork. Get commitments in writing.
- **Relater:** "Let me think about it" may mean no. Gently check.
- **Thinker:** May keep asking for data to delay decisions.
- **Director:** If you're slow, they move on. Respond same day.

Pre-Meeting Checklist

- Check their style in CRM
- Research: company, recent changes, context
- Prepare first five minutes for their style
- Set intention: "It's about them, not me."

Self-Test Before Any Marketing Material

- Am I telling them I'm good, or showing evidence?
- Is this about my company, or the client?
- Would I trust a company that said this?
- Is there a specific result I could use instead of a general claim?
- Am I giving something valuable, or just asking for something?

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